

Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover – Empathy Map Canvas

Date	31 January 2025
Team ID	HYD-METRO-2025
Project Name	Hyderabad Metro Rail – Digital Ticketing System (ServiceNow)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

About the Empathy Map Canvas

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes. It helps teams better understand their users and create effective solutions by considering the user's perspective, goals, and challenges. Below is the completed Empathy Map for the Hyderabad Metro Rail Digital Ticketing project.

User Persona: Daily Metro Commuter in Hyderabad

■ USER Hyderabad Metro Daily Commuter (Age 18–55, Working Professional / Student)

■ THINK & FEEL — What really counts

- Worried about missing the train due to slow token purchase.
- Frustrated that there is no digital booking option available.
- Aspires to have a seamless, tech-enabled travel experience.
- Concerned about carrying exact change for ticket machines.
- Thinks the metro system should adopt modern digital standards.

■ SEE — What they observe around them

- Long queues at ticket counters during peak hours (8-10 AM, 5-7 PM).
- Other commuters struggling with manual token purchase.
- Digital payment in shops/apps but not metro.
- QR code scanners already installed at metro gates.
- Ads promoting cashless India and UPI payments.

■ HEAR — What they hear

- Friends: 'Ola/Uber is faster — metro queues waste time.'
- Colleagues: 'Bangalore Namma Metro app is so convenient.'
- Social media complaints about no online HYD Metro booking.
- Govt pushing digital India and cashless ticketing.
- Station announcements about token availability.

■ SAY & DO — Actions and behaviour

- Says: 'I wish I could just scan and go without queuing.'
- Arrives 10-15 minutes early to account for queue time.
- Carries exact cash to avoid change issues at counters.
- Avoids metro during peak hours when queues are longest.
- Switches to auto/cab when they cannot afford queue delays.

■ HEAR — What they hear

- Friends say: 'I just use Ola/Uber — metro queues waste too much time.'
- Colleagues say: 'The Bangalore Namma Metro app is so convenient.'
- Social media: complaints about Hyderabad Metro not having online booking.
- News: government pushing for digital India and cashless ticketing.
- Station announcements about token availability and counter timings.

■ SAY & DO — Actions and behaviour

- Says: 'I wish I could just scan and go.'
- Arrives 10-15 minutes early just to account for queue time.
- Carries exact cash to avoid change issues at counters.
- Avoids metro during peak hours when queues are longest.
- Switches to auto/cab on days when they cannot afford queue delays.

♥ FEEL — Emotions about the experience

- Frustrated by wasted time in queues every single day.
- Anxious about missing trains during peak hours.
- Embarrassed when they don't have exact change.
- Relieved on the rare days when the queue is short.
- Envious of cities with seamless metro app experiences.

■ GOALS — What they want to achieve

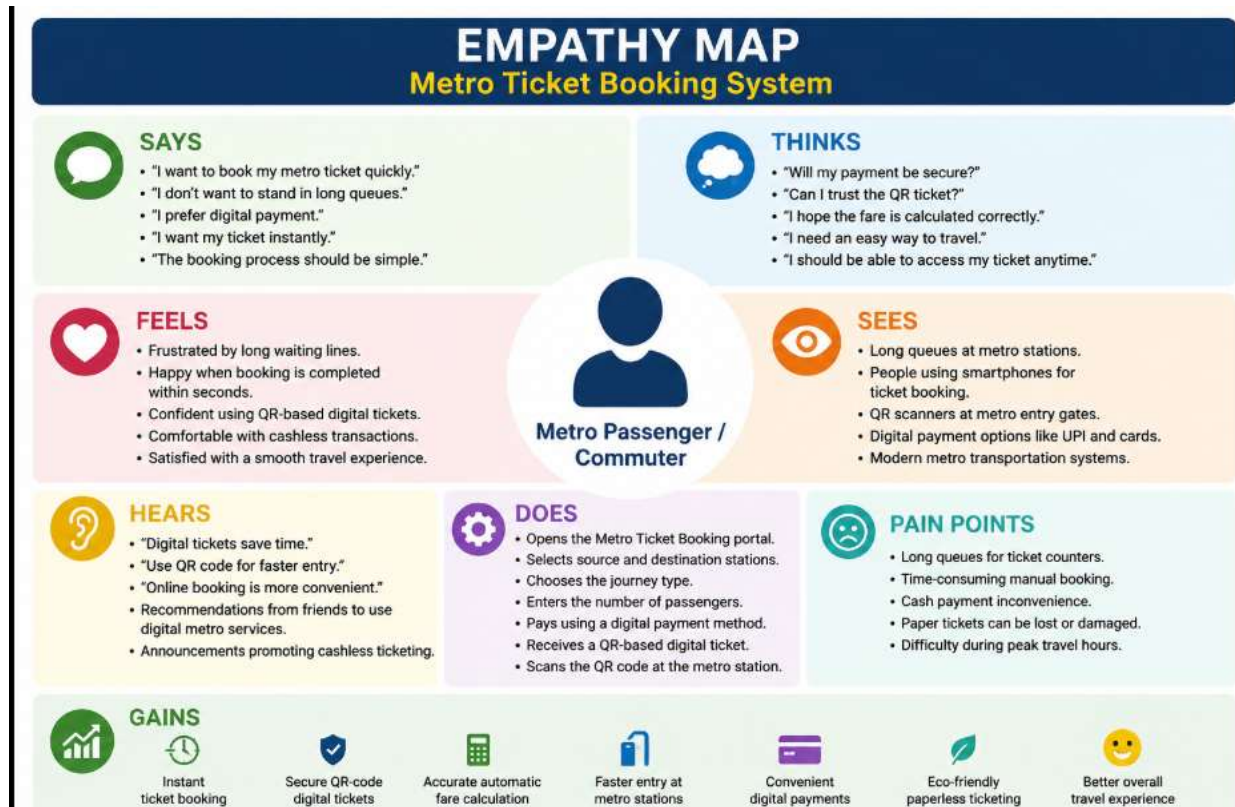
- Save 10-15 minutes daily by skipping the token counter.
- Use UPI or card to pay — no need to carry cash.
- Get a digital ticket/QR code to scan at the gate.
- Book in advance from home or office before commuting.
- Have a reliable, modern metro travel experience.

■ PAIN — Fears, frustrations & obstacles

■ GAIN — Wants, needs & measures of success

- Long queues at metro token counters daily.
- No mobile/digital booking option.
- Risk of missing trains while waiting.
- Carrying exact change is inconvenient.
- Paper tokens easy to lose.
- No receipt or digital record of journeys.
- Counter closes during odd hours.

- Book ticket in under 60 seconds from mobile.
- Get a QR code — scan and enter gate.
- Pay via UPI, card, or wallet.
- Recharge metro card online.
- Digital journey history for expense tracking.
- No dependency on physical counters.
- Receive booking confirmation instantly.



Key Insight

Hyderabad Metro commuters are digitally aware and ready to adopt a mobile-first ticketing solution. The primary barrier is not willingness but the absence of a convenient, reliable digital platform. A ServiceNow-powered portal with QR code generation, automated fare calculation, and multi-mode digital payment will directly address their core pain points and transform their daily commute experience.